



MONEY & GROWTH FOR WOMEN • FREE GUIDE

The Sales Conversation Decoder

Know what to say, and what they're really telling you.

Five moments women freeze in a sales conversation, exactly what to say instead, and a decoder for the objections you hear most, all through one simple rule: Kind, Clear, and True.

by Liz Lemarchand
Certified NLP Coach | lizlemarchand.com

You know the feeling.

The call is going well. Then it's time to say your price, and your throat tightens. You hear yourself softening the number before anyone's even reacted to it.

Or you ask the question, and there's a pause on the other end, and instead of letting it breathe, you fill it with words you didn't plan to say, a discount you didn't mean to offer, a justification nobody asked for.

Or the call ends with "let me think about it," and you say "of course, take your time," and then three weeks go by, and you still haven't followed up, because some part of you has decided that silence is safer than finding out the real answer.

If any of this is familiar, you're not bad at sales. You're not "too nice" or "not pushy enough" or missing some gene other people were born with. You froze in that moment because your nervous system decided, in real time, that going quiet was safer than being direct. That's not a personality flaw. That's a pattern. And patterns can be interrupted the moment you can name them and know exactly what to do instead.

This guide gives you two things. First, exactly what to say in the five moments where women most often freeze in a sales conversation, opening the ask, stating your price, handling silence, following up, and closing. Second, a decoder for the objections you hear most often, what they actually mean underneath the surface, and how to respond without losing yourself in the process.

Everything here follows one rule:

Kind, Clear, and True.

Not soft. Not pushy. Just honest, said out loud, without apologizing for it.

This is the starting point. Not the whole path, the starting point, one you can use in your very next conversation.

PART ONE

The Five Freeze Points

I Opening the Ask

This is the moment you have to say, out loud, that you'd like their business. Most women either bury it in a question ("Would you maybe be interested in working together, if that's something you'd want?") or avoid it entirely and hope the client brings it up first.

SAY THIS INSTEAD

"Based on everything we've talked about, I'd love to work with you on this. Here's what that would look like."

Notice what's missing. No "maybe." No "if that's something you'd want." You said the true thing. That's the whole move.

2 Stating Your Price

This is where the throat tightens for almost everyone. The instinct is to soften the number, rush past it, or immediately justify it before anyone's asked you to.

SAY THIS INSTEAD

"The investment for this is [price]."

Then stop talking.

Silence after your price is not a problem to fix. It's a moment for the other person to think. Resist the urge to fill it with a discount, a disclaimer, or an apology. The price is a fact, not an opinion you need to defend.

3

Handling Silence

A pause on the other end of a call can feel unbearable when you're used to reading silence as rejection. So you jump in, you talk faster, you start negotiating against yourself before anyone's said no.

SAY THIS INSTEAD

Nothing, for a beat.

If it goes on: "Take your time, I'll wait."

Then actually wait. Silence is not always disagreement. Sometimes it's just someone thinking. Let it be that.

4

Following Up After "Let Me Think About It"

You already know this one is where most sales quietly die, not because the answer was no, but because nobody asked again.

SAY THIS INSTEAD

"Following up on our conversation. I'd love to know where you landed and answer anything that's still unclear."

Kind. Clear. True. No apologizing for reaching out. No hedging language pretending you don't actually want an answer.

5

Closing the Conversation

The final moment, where you either ask directly for a decision or let the conversation trail off into "well, let me know."

SAY THIS INSTEAD

"What would you like to do next?"

One direct question. It respects the other person's ability to make a decision, and it respects yours enough to actually ask for one.

PART TWO

The Objection Decoder

Objections rarely mean what they sound like on the surface. Here's what's actually being said, and how to respond.

“I need to think about it.”

WHAT IT OFTEN MEANS

I'm not fully convinced yet, or I'm nervous about the money and don't want to say so directly.

SAY THIS

“Of course. What would be most helpful to think through, is there anything I can clarify right now?”

“It's too expensive.”

WHAT IT OFTEN MEANS

I don't yet see how the value outweighs the cost, or my own money story is activated.

SAY THIS

“I hear you. Can I ask what you were expecting the investment to be, so I understand where the gap is?”

“Let me check with my spouse.”

WHAT IT OFTEN MEANS

Sometimes this is literal. Sometimes it's a socially acceptable way to buy time without admitting hesitation.

SAY THIS

“Absolutely, that makes sense. What questions do you think they'll have, so we can talk through them now?”

“I’ve tried something like this before and it didn’t work.”

WHAT IT OFTEN MEANS

There’s real skepticism here, often rooted in a past disappointment, not necessarily doubt about you specifically.

SAY THIS

“That’s really useful to know. What was missing last time, so I can make sure this is different?”

“Now isn’t the right time.”

WHAT IT OFTEN MEANS

This can be true. It can also be a soft no dressed up as a scheduling issue.

SAY THIS

“Understood. Is it the timing specifically, or is there something else giving you pause?”

Notice the pattern across every response. You’re not arguing. You’re not convincing. You’re asking one honest, direct question that invites the real answer instead of accepting the polite deflection.



A Closing Thought

None of this works because of clever phrasing. It works because each response is Kind, Clear, and True, said by someone who's regulated enough in the moment to say it plainly instead of shrinking it down to feel safer.

That regulation isn't something you build alone, reading a guide once and hoping it sticks. It's built through practice, repetition, and being around other women who are doing the same uncomfortable, worthwhile work. That's exactly what happens inside Money & Growth for Women.

JOIN THE COMMUNITY

Liz Lemarchand is a certified NLP coach with over 25 years of corporate sales and marketing experience. She helps women grow their business, and just as importantly, grow into the calm, confident business leader they need to be to build real financial independence. She is the founder of Money & Growth for Women.

lizlemarchand.com